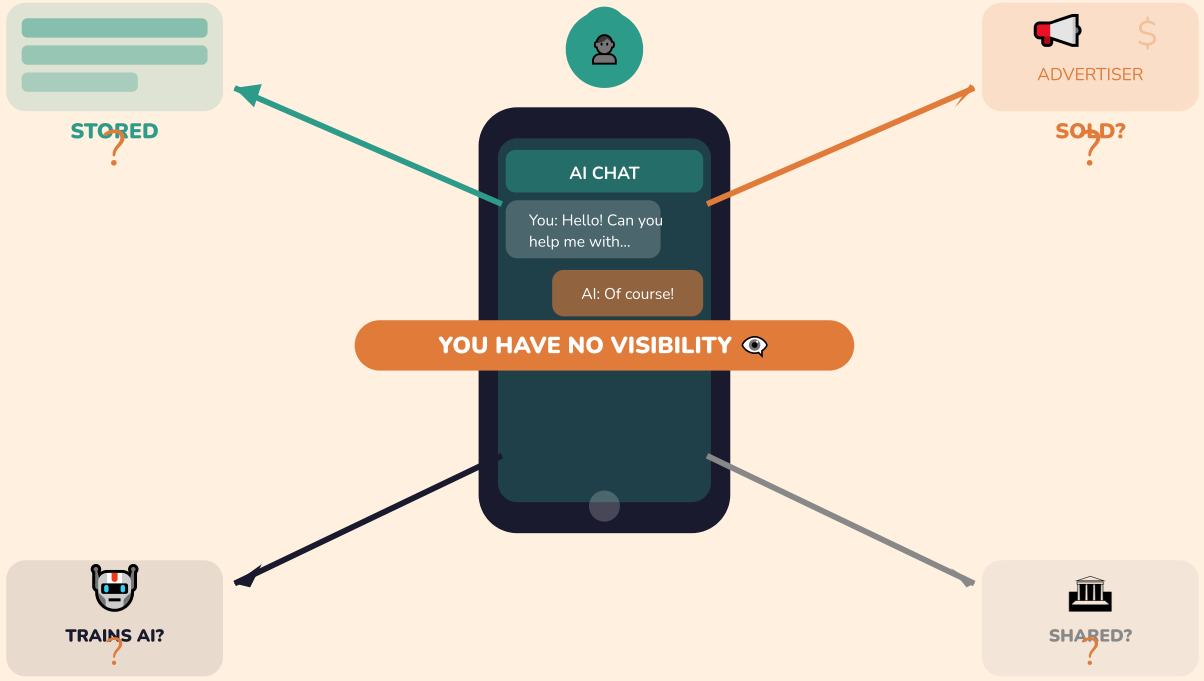
WHAT HAPPENS TO YOUR DATA?

When you use an AI tool, what do you give away?



TRACE

MAP

DECIDE

WHAT HAPPENS TO YOUR DATA?

Data privacy is abstract until students trace a single concrete action. This activity makes the chain tangible — from typing a message to how that data may be stored, analysed, or monetised.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Students open (or imagine using) a free AI chatbot. Ask: what data do you provide when you use this tool? List on the board: messages, device, location, time, topics...
2. Groups receive a "data journey" map template. Fill in each stage: user → platform → what happens? (stored? analysed? used for training? shared with advertisers?)
3. Read excerpts from two real Terms of Service — simplified. What does the platform say it can do with your data?
4. Students design a "data rights card" — three things they would want a platform to promise before they use it.

MATERIALS

- Data journey map templates
- Simplified ToS excerpts (2 services)
- Blank data rights card template
- Coloured pens for mapping
- Discussion anchor: what is "your" data?

REFLECTION

- Is "free" always free?
- Who benefits when your data is used?
- What would change if you had full control over your data?
- Would you pay for a private AI tool?

REALITY CHECK

Most AI services are free because user data has commercial value.

Conversations, preferences, and behaviour are collected, analysed, and often used to improve the AI. When you use these tools, you are also contributing to them — whether you know it or not.

DIGITAL GAME

Data Mapper

Scan to play →